

Owner SOP – AI Candidate Screening & Shortlisting System

This is the one-page guide for the recruiter who runs the system every day. You work only in the Google Sheet and your inbox. The AI scores candidates; you make every decision.

1. Your day

About 15–30 minutes a day is enough for one open role (estimate). New applications are already scored when you open the Sheet.

When	What you do	Where
Morning	Open the Candidates tab and filter <code>status = New</code> . Sort by <code>weighted_score</code> , highest first	Google Sheet
Morning	For each new candidate, read <code>ai_summary</code> , <code>score_breakdown</code> , <code>strengths</code> , <code>concerns</code> and <code>missing_info_flags</code> . Open the resume from <code>resume_drive_link</code> if unsure	Google Sheet, Drive
Morning	Set <code>recruiter_decision</code> : Advance, Hold or Reject	Google Sheet
Through the day	Read alert emails with [KNOCKOUT FAIL], [DUPLICATE], [ACTION] or [ALERT] in the subject and act on them	Your inbox
When Stage 2 results arrive	Read <code>stage2_summary</code> and <code>combined_score</code> . Check any CHECK CLAIMS line	Google Sheet + summary email
When ready to interview	Set <code>interview_decision</code> to Schedule Interview	Google Sheet
Before each interview	Open the Google Calendar event and the candidate's row	Google Calendar
Once a week	Open the Audit Log tab, filter for ERROR rows, and confirm each one was handled	Google Sheet

2. The Sheet

You type in only four columns of the Candidates tab. The system fills in everything else, so leave the other columns as they are.

Columns you edit (Candidates tab)

Column	What to put	What happens next
<code>recruiter_decision</code>	Advance, Hold or Reject (dropdown)	After the undo window, the matching email is sent. Advance also sends the Stage 2 questionnaire link
<code>decision_notes</code>	Optional: your reason, in a few words	Saved to the Audit Log with the decision
<code>decided_by</code>	Optional: your name (blank = the name in Config)	Saved with the decision
<code>interview_decision</code>	Schedule Interview (dropdown)	The candidate gets a link to book a free time in your calendar

Columns to read

Column	What it tells you
<code>status</code>	New, Knockout – Needs Review, Duplicate – Needs Review, Advanced, On Hold, Rejected, Interview Scheduled
<code>weighted_score</code> and <code>score_band</code>	Resume score out of 100 and its band: Shortlist, Review or Low match. A band is a sorting label, not a decision
<code>score_breakdown</code>	Score for each rubric criterion
<code>strengths</code> , <code>concerns</code> , <code>missing_info_flags</code>	What stood out, what to check, and what the resume leaves out
<code>knockout_result</code>	PASS or FAIL on the Yes/No form questions
<code>stage2_score</code> , <code>combined_score</code> , <code>stage2_summary</code>	Questionnaire result, combined score and any CHECK CLAIMS line
<code>decision_email_sent</code>	PENDING (waiting out the undo window), TRUE (email sent) or HOLD

Column	What it tells you
<code>interview_status</code> , <code>interview_start</code> , <code>interview_meet_link</code>	INVITED or BOOKED, the booked time and the Google Meet link

Other tabs

Tab	Who edits it
Config	The owner, only when settings change (job, thresholds, email wording, timing)
Rubric	The owner, when the job's criteria change
Questionnaire	The owner, when the Stage 2 questions change
Audit Log	Nobody. The system writes it; you read it

3. From application to interview

There are two points where you act: the first decision and the interview. The system does everything in between.

1. **System:** the candidate fills in the application form, answers 4 Yes/No questions and uploads a PDF resume. They get an acknowledgment email in about 20 seconds.
2. **System:** the resume is saved to Drive, scored against the Rubric with quoted evidence, and added to the Candidates tab. You get a summary email such as "[Shortlist 86] Name – Job".
3. **You:** review the row and set `recruiter_decision`.
 - **Advance:** the candidate gets a personal Stage 2 questionnaire link.
 - **Hold:** no email is sent. You can change it to Advance or Reject later.
 - **Reject:** a polite email is sent. It never mentions scores or AI.
4. **Undo window:** the email waits for the time set in Config (10 minutes by default). Clear the cell or pick another decision before then to cancel or change it.
5. **System:** the candidate answers the questionnaire. Answers are scored with quotes, and you get a "[Stage 2 done]" email with the combined score.
6. **You:** if you want to interview them, set `interview_decision` to Schedule Interview.
7. **System:** the candidate picks a free time from your calendar. A Google Calendar event with a Google Meet link is sent to both of you, and you get an "[Interview booked]" email.

8. **You:** run the interview and record the outcome your usual way. Hiring decisions after the interview stay outside the system in v1.0.

To reschedule: move the event in Google Calendar and choose to notify guests. To send a new booking link, clear `interview_status` and set Schedule Interview again.

4. Emails you will receive

The tag at the start of the subject tells you what to do. Emails without a tag are information only.

Subject starts with	Meaning	What to do
[Shortlist 86], [Review 62], [Low match 13]	A new candidate was scored	Review the row and set a decision
[KNOCKOUT FAIL]	The candidate answered "No" to a must-have question	Read it yourself. It is flagged, not rejected. Decide as usual
[VERIFY]	An AI quote could not be matched word for word	Open the resume and check that criterion before deciding
[DUPLICATE]	The same email applied again	Compare with the first application (<code>duplicate_of</code>). The new one is not re-scored
[Stage 2 done]	The questionnaire was scored	Read <code>stage2_summary</code> ; decide on an interview
[CHECK CLAIMS]	An answer claims more than the resume shows	Ask about it in the interview. Scores were not changed
[Interview booked]	The candidate picked a time	Check your calendar
[ACTION] No free interview slots	Your calendar had no free time in the booking window	Free up time or widen interview hours in Config, then ask the candidate to open the same link again
[ALERT] Candidate screening failed at ...	A step failed after 3 retries	See section 5

5. When something goes wrong

Most problems are a Config value or a Google connection. Fix the cause in the Sheet, and the next run works. Contact your automation specialist if the same alert comes back after a fix.

Problem	Likely cause	Fix
[ALERT] email at the AI step	AI service down, or <code>ai_model</code> in Config is wrong	Wait 10 minutes. If it repeats, check <code>ai_model</code> against the setup guide
[ALERT] email repeats every 2 minutes	An email template in Config is blank	Fill in the template named in the alert. Alerts stop on the next check
[ALERT] at a Google Sheets, Drive, Gmail or Calendar step	The Google connection expired	Ask your automation specialist to reconnect the account in n8n
A candidate says they got no acknowledgment	Wrong email typed, or it went to spam	Check the row's <code>email</code> and the Audit Log for an email row
A decision email did not go out	Still in the undo window, or the decision was misspelled	Check <code>decision_email_sent</code> . PENDING = wait. Use the dropdown values only
A wrong decision was set	Human error	Clear or change the cell before the undo window ends. After it ends, contact the candidate yourself
Candidate says the link does not work	Link expired, already used, or copied wrongly	The page says which. Expired interview link: clear <code>interview_status</code> and set Schedule Interview again. Expired Stage 2 link: contact the candidate directly (an Advance email is never sent twice)
Scores look too high or too low	Rubric anchors are unclear	Tighten the anchors in the Rubric tab and test with one sample resume
A scanned resume scored very low	The PDF has no readable text	Ask the candidate for a text-based PDF

6. Rules

1. **A person makes every decision.** The AI scores and labels; it never advances or rejects anyone. Never set decisions in bulk from the band alone.
2. **Read before you reject.** Open the evidence, and the resume when a flag says to check, before choosing Reject. A Low match can still be a good hire.
3. **Knockouts are flags, not rejections.** A "No" answer means you look closer, not that the candidate is out.
4. **Change settings in the Sheet only.** Config, Rubric and Questionnaire tabs hold every setting. Do not edit the n8n workflow.
5. **Never edit system columns or the Audit Log.** They are the record of why each candidate was scored and decided the way they were.
6. **Protect candidate data (Data Privacy Act of 2012, RA 10173).** Keep the Sheet and the Drive folder private to the hiring team. Do not download or forward resumes outside the process. Use fictional data for any test or demo.
7. **Keep candidate emails free of scores.** Edit email wording in Config, but never add scores, bands or mention of AI.
8. **Set the undo window to 10 minutes for real hiring.** 0 minutes is only for demos and tests.

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